- Handle missing values using interpolation or forward/backward filling methods.
- Normalize or standardize numerical features to ensure consistency.
- Encode categorical variables like product categories or regions if needed.
- Aggregate data to appropriate granularity (daily, weekly, or monthly) based on business requirements.

4. Model Selection and Training:
    - Train forecasting models based on the nature of the sales data:
        - **ARIMA (AutoRegressive Integrated Moving Average):** Suitable for non-seasonal time series data.
        - **SARIMA (Seasonal ARIMA):** Handles seasonal variations in sales.
        - **Prophet (by Facebook):** Robust for time series with missing data or strong seasonality.
        - **LSTM (Long Short-Term Memory networks):** For capturing non-linear patterns and long-term dependencies.
    - Split data into training and test sets, reserving the most recent data for validation.
    - Tune hyperparameters using grid search or automated tools like Optuna.

5. Model Evaluation:
    - Use metrics like:
        - Mean Absolute Error (MAE)
        - Mean Squared Error (MSE)
        - Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE)